

Of AOL and Interoperability

AOL is no stranger to interoperability issues. The latest casualty in the instant messaging phenomenon is Trillian, which allows messaging applications from Yahoo!, MSN, and AIM to be accessed through one interface. AOL claims that accessing its software service through Trillian for messaging purposes is the same as hacking into its software. Similar incidents have happened with AOL in the past. The company considered this a security breach and blocked Trillian from accessing its software, but at the same

time, it continues conducting research to create interoperable services. AOL plans to come up with something similar to the e-mail (wherein



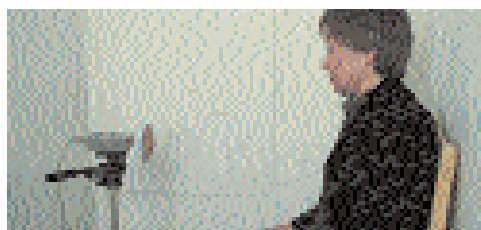
users can use disparate services but still contact each other). Meanwhile, AOL is restructuring its music and video products business in India and has approached FIPB to set up a subsidiary.

Wireless ECG

A student at the University of Sussex, UK, has built a sensor that can pick up your heartbeat without making any physical contact with your body. The device can pick up changes in the electric field in the air due to a shift in voltages on

in diameter and capable of picking up your heartbeat even at a distance of a metre. The impedance of the sensor was made 100 times higher than that of air in order to retain the signals unlike in the usual ECG sensors, which drain the electrical

signals. The student at the helm of this project states that normal ECG suffers a distortion since the skin



the skin surface. This is called the displacement current, which is used for drawing the ECG graphs. The sensor in this device is a powerful copper disc, 1 cm

retards the flow of electrical signals. The device can be used to monitor patients, such as fire accident victims, who cannot be touched while treatment.

Visual Studio .NET in India

Microsoft's .NET strategy for online services has been at the centre of considerable excitement, debate and even apprehension for a while now. The much-touted Visual Studio .NET, which is a tool targeted at developing Web serv-

ices specifically for the .NET platform, was finally released on 13th of February 2002 in India. The toolkit supports nearly 20 programming languages, including the already popular Visual C++, Java and newer ones like C#. As an

increasing number of developers and companies look at the development of Web services, this will allow the use of existing skills to move on to the Web services platforms. A true developer tool, but God knows what the hidden tag is.



heroes

PALM

Palm scores a winner with the new i705 wireless PDA USB 2.0

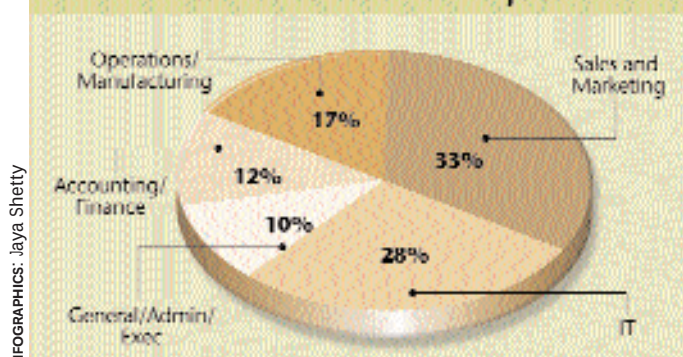
Speeding ahead with 480 Mbps

PIXAR

Animation stalwart on a high after the release of the blockbuster, *Monster Inc*

statattack

Internet related non-IT jobs



INFOGRAPHICS: Jaya Shetty

Source: www.internetindicators.com

Cracking XP

Windows Product Activation was introduced as a move to prevent piracy of Windows XP. This supposedly watertight user authentication system has been recently put to shame by a key generating program that is able to produce valid activation keys that are accepted by the latest Windows OS. Microsoft is again faced with the task of devising a mechanism which will recognise the difference between genuine and cracked keys.



zeroes

MPEG-4

Institution of usage fees for streaming MPEG-4 dampens enthusiasm for the format

MICROSOFT

New Windows licensing rules may impose harsher terms on PC manufacturers